

CATEGORY	Hardware compatibility			
Distribution name	Xandros	Lycoris	Lindows 3.0	ELX
Graphics card				
nVidia GeForce MX 440 with AGP8x	✓	✗	✓	✓
nVidia GeForce2 MX 400	✗	✓	✓	✗
nVidia GeForce2 MX 200	✗	✗	✓	✓
NVIDIA Riva TNT2	✓	✗	✓	✓
SiS 6326	✓	✗	✓	✓
Ethernet card				
Broadcom NetXtreme	✗	✗	✗	✓
Gigabit ethernet card				
Intel Pro 100 VE	✗	✗	✓	✗
Dlink DFE-538TX 10/100	✓	✗	✓	✓
Intel EtherExpress PRO 100	✓	✗	✓	✓
Sound card				
Onboard CMI 8378	✓	✗	✗	✓
Onboard 5.1 support	✗	✗	✗	✗
Onboard Realtek AC'97	✓	✗	✗	✓
Aureal2	✓	✗	✓	✗
Yamaha DS-XG	✓	✗	✓	✓
Optical drives				
Samsung SW-240B CD-RW	✓	✓	✓	✗
Samsung SD-616Q DVD-ROM	✓	✓	✓	✗
Samsung SD-612 DVD-ROM	✗	✗	✓	✓
Samsung SM-348B Combo Drive	✗	✗	✓	✓
Modem				
Best data 56 Kbps data fax modem	✗	✗	✗	✗
Overall score	0.57	0.14	0.67	0.62

Xandros 1.0: The best of the lot



The Xandros installation procedure is very simple. It gives two modes of install: Express install, and Custom Install. Express install does not allow partitioning of the hard drive, but preserves existing Windows partitions. Custom install, on the other hand, lets the user partition the hard drive.

After logging in for the first time, a First Run Wizard allows the user to configure the network, printers, etc., in a very intuitive fashion. For example, to configure a printer using the First Run Wizard, just select the type of printer (local or remote) and give the relevant information in the steps that follow. If you do not configure a peripher-

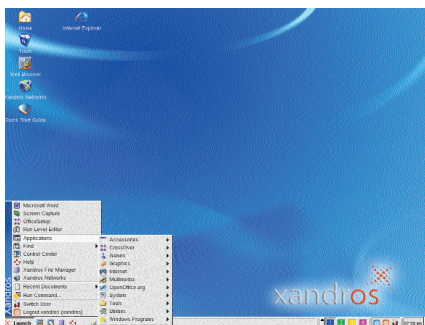
al device, using the wizard, you can do so later using the Control Centre.

Sharing files on a Windows network is also very easy. In the Control Centre just go to **Networking > Windows Networking**, enter the name of your workgroup, and you're done. You can now access the other computers on the network using the File Manager by going to **Home > Windows Network**. Search for other computers on the network, by going to **Find > Computers** in the main menu.

The Xandros desktop is basically a variant of the K Desktop Environment (KDE). Many of the tools that are available via the Launch menu are standard KDE tools. For example, the Process Manager runs the kpm tool, and the Run Level Editor is nothing but the ksysv application with the -caption option.

Clicking on the Windows key on the keyboard brings up the Launch menu—just as it brings up the Start menu under Windows. Such small improvements make the user much more comfortable with the GUI environment.

Xandros is considerably faster than the other distributions and provides a very intuitive and easy to use GUI. It even supports active user switching, just as in Windows XP. The users can switch even if their applications are running on their



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